DIRECTORATE
MAHARASHTRA
TOURISM

KAILASH TEMPLE
- ELLORA CAVES

MAHARASHTRA

THE LAND OF TIMELESS & ENIGMATIC CAVES

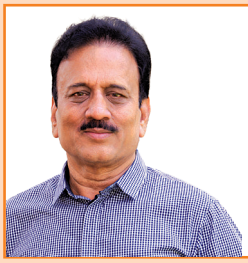
The caves of Maharashtra are not just architectural marvels; they are repositories of history, art, and spirituality. Each cave complex offers a unique glimpse into the past, showcasing the religious diversity and artistic achievements of ancient India. As we explore these enigmatic structures, we gain a deeper appreciation for the cultural and historical legacy they represent. Home to numerous significant Buddhist sites, Maharashtra's caves served as sanctuaries for meditation, monastic living, and artistic expression, reflecting the integration of natural landscapes with religious devotion. You will need to witness first hand, the aesthetic amalgamation of art, ancient architecture, engineering skills and spirituality that have stood the test of time and nature.


ELEPHANTA CAVES

KANHERI CAVES, Borivali, Mumbai
Located in Sanjay Gandhi National Park, the Kanheri Caves were founded by monks from Sopara in the 1st century BCE. The complex flourished until the 16th century and includes significant caves such as Cave 3 (the main chaitya), Cave 11 (used for Mahayana rituals), and Cave 41 (housing the oldest image of Bodhisattva Eleven Headed Avalokiteshwara).
Nearby Sights: Sanjay Gandhi National Park, Global Vipassana Pagoda, Mandapeshwara, Jogeshwari Caves, Mahakali Caves.

MAHAKALI CAVES, Jogeshwari, Mumbai
Located in Mumbai, the Mahakali Caves date back to the 1st century BCE and served as a monastery until the 12th century CE. The site includes 19 rock-cut caves with Chaityas and Viharas, featuring beautiful sculptures and inscriptions.
Nearby Sights: Jogeshwari Caves, Powai Lake, Bandra Fort, Elephanta Caves, Mount Mary Church, Worli Fort.

ELEPHANTA CAVES, Elephanta Island
The Elephanta Caves, located on an island near the Gateway of India, showcase impressive Indian architecture from the 2nd century. Declared a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 1986, these caves include Cave 1, featuring a 7-foot Sadashiva statue and the Trimurti. Visitors can reach the island



"These caves are not just geological formations; they are a treasure trove of art, spirituality, and architectural ingenuity that reflect the ingenuity of our ancestors. From the awe-inspiring Ajanta and Ellora caves, which are UNESCO World Heritage Sites, to the lesser-known but equally mesmerizing rock-cut caves, each site tells a story that spans centuries, revealing the intertwined narratives of religion, commerce, and daily life in ancient Maharashtra. It is incumbent upon us to preserve and promote these caves, not only as relics of our past but as vital components of our cultural identity and tourism potential. Our government is committed to increasing awareness about these historical gems, facilitating sustainable tourism practices that honor our responsibility to both the environment and our heritage. We aim to ensure that these caves are maintained for future generations to appreciate and learn from, as they encapsulate the artistry and spirituality that have defined our civilization".

GIRISH MAHAJAN, Minister Of Tourism, Government Of Maharashtra